

LUCKNOW | Family Planning



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI / www.indiatodayimages.com

After Mulayam Singh Yadav, brother Shivpal Singh Yadav and son Akhilesh, there is a new entrant from the Samajwadi Party chief's family who is jumping into the rough and tumble of

DIMPLE YADAV

politics. Mulayam's daughter-in-law Dimple Yadav is taking on the Congress' Raj Babbar and the BSP's S.P. Singh Baghel in the November 7 bypoll for the Firozabad Lok Sabha seat vacated by her husband Akhilesh. In the May elections, the SP had not fielded candidates against Sonia and Rahul Gandhi, expecting that the Congress would reciprocate in future polls. Dimple's slogan on the campaign trail: "It's a matter of prestige for Netaji (Mulayam)."

But Rahul's decision to campaign against Dimple has enraged the SP, which did not expect a Congress candidate. Which dynasty has its way remains to be seen.

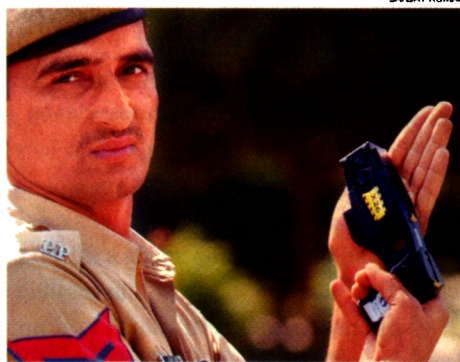
by Farzand Ahmed

Tale End

Vasundhara Raje's recent resignation as leader of the Opposition in Rajasthan has a BJP elder quipping, "He who gives is blessed, he who doesn't is also blessed". The reference is to L.K. Advani who is resisting quitting despite the RSS's clear signals.

DELHI | Stunning Debut

Indian policemen have veered between two extremes—either beating a citizen to pulp or shooting him with a lethal .303 rifle. Now with the introduction of technologies like electroshock guns, they have a safer, less lethal alternative to subdue violent or fleeing suspects and to control mobs. The police's newest acquisition is the Taser, a hand-held electro-shock device. The "gun" fires two darts that emit a mild electric current that disrupts the body's muscular controls, temporarily immobilising the suspect. The Punjab Police has taken the lead with over 80 Tasers issued to its men. Police forces of other states like J&K, Delhi, Madhya Pradesh and the



SANJAY KUMAR

A PUNJAB POLICEMAN WITH THE TASER

National Security Guards' anti-hijack teams have it on order ensuring a late but stunning debut.

by Sandeep Unnithan

KOLKATA |

Clean Stroke

The apparent apathy of civic authorities has goaded citizens to clear Kolkata's image of being a "huge rubbish dump" through a cleanliness drive called Calcutta Sparkling. What was started by a bunch of school kids to clear up their neighbourhood boulevard on Southern Avenue in South Kolkata has snowballed into a much bigger drive that has the support of

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THE CALCUTTA SPARKLING DRIVE AT THE MAIDAN

the army, Kolkata Police and people from all walks of life and ages. On any given day on the Maidan about 45 volunteers, mostly from the Khalsa High School, clear out the debris that has built up over decades. Students and citizens have already cleared out garbage from the Safari Park, Rabindra Sarobar, Southern Avenue boulevard, Park Circus Maidan and the Maidan-Chowringhee stretch. Australian cricketer Steve Waugh had joined in as a volunteer at the Thakurpukur Canal.

by Elora Sen